FLOSS: A PARENT PAGE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

One page for the adult helping at home. Nothing to fill in.

What your child is learning. In a short word of one syllable with one short vowel, the f, l, s or z at the end gets written twice: cliff, bell, grass, buzz. Teachers call it the FLOSS rule, or sometimes the 1-1-1 rule, because of the three checks below. It is one of the most useful spelling rules there is, because it covers hundreds of common words and it almost always holds.

A FIVE-MINUTE ROUTINE

1	**Say the word**	You say it, the child says it back. One word at a time, never a list.
2	**Run the three checks**	One syllable? One short vowel? Ends in f, l, s or z? Three yeses means double it.
3	**Write it, then check it**	The child writes the word, then underlines the last two letters and reads it back.
4	**Use it in a sentence**	Out loud is enough. This is where the meaning sticks.

Double or not

You say a word, the child holds up two fingers for a double letter and one for a single. Mix in the exceptions: bus, gas, yes, plus, this, was.

Spot the error

Write five words with two spelled wrong (bel, grass, buz, doll, miss). The child finds and fixes them. Swap roles.

Word hunt

Hunt for FLOSS words in a book you are already reading. Ten minutes, keep a tally on the back of this page.

TWELVE WORDS FOR HOME PRACTICE

cliff stuff bell spell hill doll grass class cross miss buzz fizz

The words that break the rule. if, of, is, as, has, was, his, us, bus, gas, this, yes, plus, pal, nil. Do not try to reason these out with your child: they are learned by sight. If your child doubles the letter in one of them, say "that one is a rule breaker" and move on.

What progress looks like. First your child doubles the letter when you remind them. Then they do it on the sheet without a reminder. Last, and this is the one that matters, they do it in a story they are writing, where nobody has told them to think about spelling. That last step can take a few months, so keep the sessions short and keep going.

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